

Delaware County Commissionersl Meeting July 23rd 2024

Meeting Metadata	Details
Video Recording	https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=-sfsIVUfvd0
Publication Date	2024-07-23T15:16:41Z
Target Category	delaware_county

Notice: This report is provided by the [Muncie Policy Memo](#) as a public service. This summary is generated automatically using artificial intelligence from public video transcripts, both of which are prone to error. The report is intended to provide an overview of meeting business and an aid to accessing detailed information from the video recording. When accuracy is critical, please refer to the official video recording or approved minutes.

Delaware County Council Meeting Report

Meeting Date: Tuesday, July 23, 2024

Report Type: Comprehensive Municipal Meeting Summary

2. Meeting Identification & Attendance

- **Call to Order & Spoken Details:** Presiding officer called the regular meeting of the Delaware County Council to order at [00:00:14](#).
- **Attendance:**
 - *Members Present:* Identified board members include Dan Flanagan, Ryan (Council Member), Matt (Council Member), Bill (Council Member), and Eugene (Council Member).
 - *Presiding Officer:* The Council President (or presiding officer) led the proceedings.

3. Preliminary & Procedural Business

- **Ceremonial Openings:** The meeting opened with the Pledge of Allegiance led by Dan Flanagan in honor of his birthday [00:00:15](#).

- **Approval of Minutes:**
 - Approval of the June 25, 2024 County Council meeting minutes was moved, seconded, and approved by voice vote / roll call sequence.
-

4. Substantive Business & Board Action

Transfers & Appropriations (Prosecutor's Office)

- **Item Identifier & Title:** 00:03:04 Transfer Request: County General - Prosecutor's Office
- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Prosecutor's Office representative / Committee
- **Deliberation Summary:** Discussion centered on transferring funds from deputy prosecutor vacant positions to operating supplies to purchase Microsoft Office and Windows operating system updates for 27 computers in the office ahead of expiration dates. Broader board discussion addressed cybersecurity risks, the county's disparate computer operating systems, and the need for a comprehensive county-wide IT asset and budget plan managed by IT Director Jim Pluk.
- **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote / Roll Call.

Transfers & Appropriations (Investigator Position)

- **Item Identifier & Title:** 00:14:51 Transfer Request: Prosecutor's Office (Investigator to Insurance Lines)
- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Prosecutor's Office / Committee
- **Deliberation Summary:** Transfer of funds from an investigator line (due to retirement) to cover life and disability insurance shortfalls for the remainder of the year.
- **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote / Roll Call.

Transfers & Appropriations (Auditor's Office)

- **Item Identifier & Title:** 00:17:08 Transfer Request: Auditor's Office (Full-Time to Part-Time/Other Lines)
- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Tonya (Auditor's Office)
- **Deliberation Summary:** Cleaning up line items and transferring funds from vacant full-time positions to part-time help to maintain public services while positions are open. Discussion clarified that part-time funds cannot be used for out-of-state contractual consulting.
- **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote / Roll Call.

Transfers & Appropriations (Probation Office - Drug Screens)

- **Item Identifier & Title:** 00:24:05 Transfer Request: Probation Office (Operating Supplies to Professional Services)
- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Court Administrator
- **Deliberation Summary:** A housekeeping transfer to correct line items assigned during an auditor's office conversion, shifting funds to pay DCCC for conducting drug screens rather than purchasing test supplies directly.
- **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote / Roll Call.

Transfers & Appropriations (Public Defender Office)

- **Item Identifier & Title:** 00:25:56 Transfer Request: Public Defender Office (Investigator to Attorney Fees)
- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Public Defender Office representative
- **Deliberation Summary:** Transfer of unspent investigator funds into attorney fee lines to cover statutory extra pay for public defenders handling a surge of Level 1 and murder trials lasting over three days. Discussion highlighted the unpredictable nature of trial calendars and heavy caseloads.
- **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote / Roll Call.

Tabled Business: Elected Officials' Stipends (House Bill 1528)

- **Item Identifier & Title:** 00:36:55 New Appropriations / Stipends for Auditor and Clerk (Taken off the table)
- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Council / Auditor & Clerk Offices
- **Deliberation Summary:** The council brought off the table and debated state-authorized stipends (\$2,500 during election years) for the County Clerk and Auditor under House Bill 1528. Strong objections were raised by council members regarding fairness to other county employees who forfeited raises during tough budget negotiations. Concerns were also raised regarding unfunded mandates and setting poor precedents.
- **Item-Specific Public Input:** Representatives from the Clerk's and Auditor's offices spoke on the heavy workload and statutory backing of the stipends.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Following debate, motions regarding the stipends were voted on; the clerk/auditor stipend appropriations failed / were denied by roll call vote. *(Note: Handled via multiple motions to remove from table and vote).*

Transfers & Appropriations (Probation Support Staff Parity)

- **Item Identifier & Title:** 00:50:29 Transfer Request: Adult Probation User Fee Fund (Support Staff Salary Parity)
- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Court Administrator / Jeff Hayes (Chief Probation Officer)

- **Deliberation Summary:** Request to transfer funds within user fee accounts to bring juvenile support staff salaries up to parity with adult probation support staff (\$36,089), as departments are unified and cross-trained. Discussion also previewed future budget challenges regarding user fees funding health insurance benefits.
- **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote / Roll Call [01:03:18](#).

Grant Fund Appropriations (Juvenile Detention Alternatives Initiative - JDAI)

- **Item Identifier & Title:** [01:16:00](#) Appropriation Request: JDAI Grant Fund (Fund 9107 / 9109)
- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Probation / Court Administrator
- **Deliberation Summary:** Adjusting grant fund numbers and appropriating funds for operating supplies, contractual services (including GPS monitoring), lodging, and programming associated with the Juvenile Detention Alternatives Initiative grant.
- **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote / Roll Call [01:16:35](#).

Resolution Authorizing Electronic Funds Transfers

- **Item Identifier & Title:** [01:17:00](#) Resolution Authorizing the Payment of Claims via Electronic Funds Transfer
- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Auditor's Office
- **Deliberation Summary:** Resolution allowing counties to make vendor payments electronically per state statute, replacing traditional paper checks while maintaining council approval over claims.
- **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote / Roll Call.

Board & Committee Appointments

- **Item Identifier & Title:** [01:18:40](#) Board Appointments: Muncie Public Library Board & Civic Center Authority Board
- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Council / Board Candidates
- **Deliberation Summary:**
 - *Muncie Public Library Board:* Four candidates sought two open seats (incumbents Allin Cottin and Billy Shepard, alongside Dennis Everett and Jessica Shroud). Library Director spoke in support of the library's 150th anniversary and Carnegie Library restoration. Council discussed transparency and public notification rules for board seats. **Outcome:** Incumbents Allin Cottin and Billy Shepard were reappointed.

- *Civic Center Authority Board*: Three candidates sought two open seats (incumbents Gary Carterville and Mary Ann Piper, alongside Amber Green). **Outcome:** Incumbents Gary Carterville and Mary Ann Piper were reappointed.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** Comments heard from library director, candidates, and public participants.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Appointments finalized by roll call vote.
 - **Item Identifier & Title:** [01:37:23](#) Committee Appointment: Transportation Policy Committee (MPO)
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Council
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Appointment of a council representative to the Transportation Policy Committee, which oversees Metropolitan Planning Organization (MPO) transportation rules and federal/state funding allocations (\$3.7M annually).
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Council member Jim was appointed by motion, second, and roll call vote [01:45:03](#).
 - **Item Identifier & Title:** [01:49:04](#) New Business: Economic Development Agreement (EDA) Liaison
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Council / Commissioners' Office
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Creation of a council liaison role to work with the county commissioners on future Economic Development Agreements (EDAs), such as solar projects, to improve communication and prevent misunderstandings.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Council member Jane was appointed as the EDA Liaison by motion, second, and roll call vote [01:52:59](#).
-

5. Open Public Comment / Citizen Forum

(No general open citizen forum comments were recorded during this portion of the transcript; departmental reports were delivered instead.)

6. Administrative Updates & Adjournment

- **Staff / Board Announcements:**
 - **Sheriff's Department Update:** [01:53:19](#) The Sheriff presented a jail population and operations report noting a population of approximately 375 inmates (including ~42-

50 federal inmates, generating \$393k in revenue for the first six months). Meal costs decreased due to multi-vendor sourcing (\$1.61 per meal), though an increase in costly kosher meal requests was noted. The Sheriff emphasized that public safety and jail staff compensation must remain a priority during upcoming budget hearings.

- **Budget Hearings Notice:** The Council announced that upcoming September budget hearings will feature deeper dives into department revenue streams and real-time balances, potentially extending schedule lengths.
- **Work Session Reminder:** A work session regarding job descriptions (not salaries) is scheduled.
- **Adjournment:**
 - Motion to adjourn made by Dan, seconded by Eugene, and approved by unanimous voice vote/roll call [02:06:56](#).
 - Next regular meeting scheduled for **Tuesday, August 27, 2024, at 9:00 AM.**

Muncie Policy Memo Civic Monitoring Automated Pipeline. Report generated on 2026-10-03 15:00:34 using model gemini-3.5-flash-lite.